

SpiritCarriesOn-DT -- The Spirit Carries On by Dream Theater

Metropolis Pt. 2: Scenes from a Memory, 1999. ~76 BPM, est.

This is DT's ballad, not the prog-metal aggression -- restrained verses that build into a huge, gospel-choir-backed climax at the end. The bass part sits warm and supportive, not technical.

GP-5 only, Sire fretless (Active), no pedalboard.

AMP: Mess Bass (Mesa/Boogie Bass 400) + CAB: EBS410 IR (User IR 4)

Rebuilt 2026-09-18 on the GP-5's own AMP + a loaded IR. Kept that way in the 2026-09-25 snaptone pass: Mess Bass is a direct model of the Mesa bass rig Myung used, and the ProgSVT snaptone is only an SVT stand-in. Mess Bass at low gain gives the same clean, no-grind lift the Harmonic Booster capture provided; EBS410 is ir.md's own recommendation for clean bass tones, which suits a warm, emotional fretless ballad.

- Gain: 30 -- kept low. This isn't a grind tone, it's a clean lift.
- VOL: 62
- Bass: 55 -- solid low end without getting flabby, lets the fretless glide sit underneath the vocal.
- Middle: 50 -- flat, neutral, doesn't fight the piano/vocal in the mix.
- Treble: 48 -- soft top end so fret-noise and string squeak from the fretless don't poke through.
- CAB VOL: 58.

Module chain

NR -- Gate, always on.

THRE: 25. Light setting -- clean NAM at low gain doesn't need aggressive gating, just enough to kill hiss between phrases.

PRE -- Micro Boost, on CTL.

Gain: 35 when engaged.

Off for the restrained verses. On for the climax -- a clean volume/harmonic push into the choir-backed ending, not a tone change.

DST -- off.

No drive anywhere in this patch. The song's power comes from dynamics and arrangement, not distortion.

AMP -- Mess Bass, always on. Gain 30, VOL 62, Bass 55, Middle 50, Treble 48.

CAB -- User IR 4 (EBS410), always on. VOL 58.

EQ -- Bass EQ 2, always on.

50Hz: +3, 120Hz: +2, 400Hz: -3, 800Hz: -1, 4.5kHz: +3, VOL: 55.

Small low-end reinforcement and a light 400Hz cut to keep the fretless from getting boxy, plus a gentle 4.5kHz lift so the note attack stays audible under the vocal and piano.

MOD -- B-Chorus, always on.

Depth: 18, Rate: 0.4Hz, VOL: 52.

Very light -- per the "light hand" rule, this sits under the tone rather than announcing itself. Just enough shimmer to give the fretless glide some width, a texture choice that stays the same in both CTL states.

DLY -- off. Kept out entirely -- a delay trail would blur the dynamic contrast between the quiet verses and the climax, which is the whole point of this patch.

RVB -- Hall, on CTL.

Mix: 45, Decay: 65, Trail: true.

Off for the verse -- dry, close, intimate.

On for the climax -- a big hall swell alongside the boost, matching the gospel-choir scale of the ending.

CTL footswitch

Two modules on CTL: PRE (Micro Boost) and RVB (Hall).

- **CTL off** -- verse/build sound. Dry, close, restrained. This is the resting state the patch loads into.
- **CTL on** -- climax sound. Boosted and washed in hall reverb, matching the huge choir-backed ending.

Engage CTL only for the final climax section -- everything before that stays in the off state, including the song's earlier dynamic swells, since the real "big" moment is reserved for the ending.